

SENATE RESOLUTION 354

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend Malcolm Louis Wallace on the occasion of his seventy-ninth birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Malcolm Louis Wallace will celebrate his seventy-ninth birthday on July 25, 2026, a milestone to be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Wallace has lived an amazing life and has experienced firsthand the breadth and span of American history; he also contributed to that history as a veteran, having served in the United States Army during the Vietnam era and the Army Reserve for more than ten years; and

WHEREAS, wholly devoted to service above self, Mr. Wallace has held the post of Senior Partner and CEO of CLW & Associates, LLC (Memphis CUEST) for more than forty-five years and has extensive experience managing anti-poverty programs; and

WHEREAS, for more than half a century, Malcolm Wallace has worked throughout Tennessee and the Mississippi Delta region, providing technical and management assistance to numerous organizations, agencies, and municipalities in his areas of expertise—housing, economic and community development, workforce development, job training and placement, welfare reform, entrepreneurial training and business creation, grant development, and program operation; and

WHEREAS, a trusted leader in his profession, Mr. Wallace is a former vice chair for the Shelby County Families First Advisory Council and served as the western at-large representative to the Tennessee Department of Human Services Advisory Council and as a

consultant to the Mississippi Department of Human Services, and he provides pro-bono technical assistance to several FBOs in the Delta region; and

WHEREAS, he served as a Specialist Assistant for Economic and Minority Business Development for Governor Lamar Alexander and Governor Don Sundquist, and he currently serves as the Chief Operating Officer and Director of Workforce Development for the South Memphis Renewal Community Development Corporation. He is also the Volunteer Regional Director of AARP Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Malcolm Wallace is a Life Member of Alpha Phi Alpha, Inc., and a charter member of the Sigma Rho Lambda Chapter in Bartlett, Mississippi; in 2009, he became the First National President of the Tennessee State Athletic Association, the national supporter group for the Tennessee State University Athletic Department; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Wallace holds a Bachelor of Arts degree in Business Administration and Pre-Law from Tennessee State University, a Juris Doctorate from the University of Illinois College of Law, and an MBA from Southern New Hampshire University, as well as several certificates from the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many worthy endeavors, he has enjoyed the love and support of his wife of twenty-eight years, Delores Chester Wallace; stepchildren, Johnsie Wallace Gault and Jon-Michael Wallace; and granddaughters, Cheyenne Ford Wallace and Kendall Elaine Wallace; and

WHEREAS, Malcolm Wallace is a joy to be around and a blessing to all who have the good fortune of knowing him; and

WHEREAS, as Mr. Wallace marks his seventy-ninth birthday, he remains a beloved member of his community who is admired for his faith, integrity, and enthusiasm for life; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and congratulate Malcolm Louis Wallace on the celebration of his seventy-ninth birthday and extend to him our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.